



KNOW HOW



Q A few weeks ago I installed openSUSE 11.1, which came bundled with your magazine, on my laptop. I have a partition with Windows XP, so it installed GRUB with no defects. After a complete installation, I tried to boot Windows from the GRUB menu, but it failed to load and displayed "A data read error occurred, press 'ctrl-alt-del' to restart." Then, after trying a lot, I removed openSUSE and installed Sabayon4; yet still Windows didn't boot up. I am quite comfortable with Linux, but I need Windows for some games and most importantly, 'AutoCAD'. Please help me out.

—Adfar Khan, adfar.khan@gmail.com

I would recommend you try re-installing Windows XP again. After reinstalling it, you will not be able to boot into Linux, as your GRUB will be overwritten by the Windows bootloader. Reinstall GRUB using the openSUSE install DVD to configure your dual boot system—check the rescue system options in the DVD.

Q I have started using Mandriva for the last few months. I use it to browse and for other desktop needs. I am very happy with it, as I do not need to update mundane things like anti-virus software, every day. Yesterday I came across the term, 'shell script'. Please tell me what it means and what it is used for.

—Vishal Abbi, Bokaro

A shell is a command-line interpreter, and a shell script is a script written for the shell. Normally, shells are interactive. It means shells accept commands from you and execute them. You can use commands one by one on the shell prompt. This sequence of commands can be stored in a text file and this text file can be executed by the shell. This is known as shell scripting. There are different shells. All Bourne Shell scripts should begin with the sequence

```
#!/bin/sh
```

On the first line of an interpreter script, following the "#!", is the name of a program that should be used to interpret the contents of the text file.

Q I have installed openSUSE 11.1 along with Windows XP on my old laptop. Everything is working fine except for the wireless. My laptop is a Compaq Presario C300 with a Celeron processor and 1 GB of RAM. Please help me to configure my wireless.

—Pradeep Shakya, Bareilly

I assume that you are able to connect to the Internet using your wired interface. Compaq Presario C300 has the Broadcom Corporation BCM4311 (rev 01) wireless network controller. OpenSUSE 11.1 does not support this wireless card out of the box. To install it, go to <http://software.opensuse.org/search> and search for *broadcom-wl*. You will get the package containing Broadcom's IEEE 802.11a/b/g/n hybrid Linux device driver for use with Broadcom's BCM4311. Click on the *1-Click Install* icon and follow the on-screen instructions. Make sure that the wireless card is installed on your laptop by running the following command as the root user:

```
lspci | grep -i broad
```

After this, restart your computer and configure the wireless card.

Q I use Fedora on my desktop. It sometimes happens that when I press the *Eject* button of the DVD/CD drive, nothing happens. I can eject the disk only by rebooting the system. Is there any way by which I can eject the disk without rebooting?

—Ramakrishnan R., Banga

You do not need to reboot your system just to eject a disk from the drive. If pressing the *Eject* button fails, try the following method. Simply right click on the CD/DVD icon on your desktop and select the *Eject/Unmount* option. If even this does not work, then run the following command:

```
$ df
```

Shown below is a sample output for the above command:

```
/dev/hda6      11079832
6877124  3630796  66% /tmp
/tmp/PCBSD7.1-x86-DVD.iso
1902720  1902720    0 100%
/tmp/test
/dev/hdc              693064
693064      0 100% /media/LFYCD_
March08
/dev/hda2            14877092
13689076  420112  98% /home/hdd
```

This tells us that */dev/hdc* is our CD/DVD-ROM drive. Now use the following command as the root:

```
# fuser -km /dev/hdc
```

Now you should be able to eject your disk. **END**